

Building a Discord bot



Bobby-B to the rescue

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One of the most ridiculously popular gaming chat clients to have breached into the mainstream is

Discord. There are servers for practically every topic under the sun, and the addition of numerous features is what really differentiates Discord from the rest of the chat clients. One of the key features that makes Discord so versatile are the bots and there are plenty of those to go around as well. Bots have a number of functions such as greeting new users, performing crowd control, moderating chat channels, performing giveaways, playing music, playing mini-games, etc. in your chat channels. Practically any task can be easily automated using just a bit of javascript.

We're all big fans of Game of Thrones here at Digit, except for the last season. And one of our favourite

subreddits is /r/freefolk. If you've been to that subreddit then you should be familiar with the resident Bobby-B-Bot who happens to be a bot that spews Robert Baratheon's quotes each time it is evoked. Folks can never really have enough of Bobby-B and it can be clearly seen that the bot really adds to the interactivity of the subreddit and makes conversations a lot more entertaining. Naturally, when we couldn't find a bot for Discord, we thought of creating the same. All it has to do is pull a quote from a list and send it

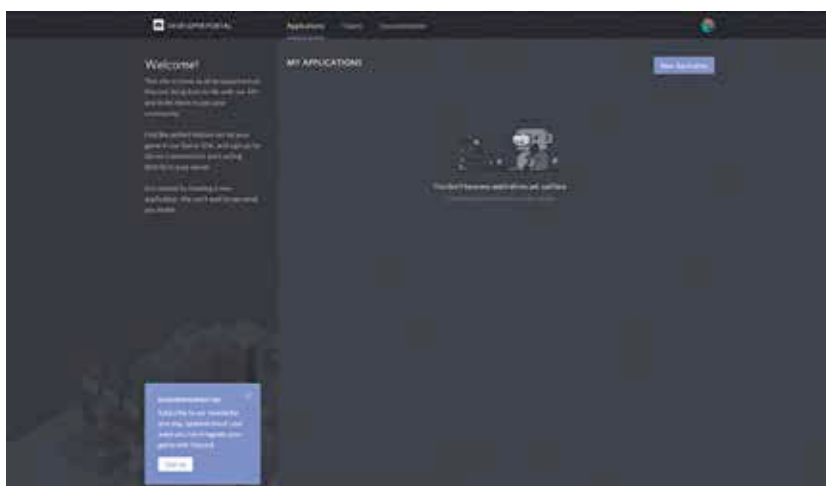
into the chat channel whenever it is evoked or if the bot is tagged by any user. Even we have a Discord channel for SKOAR!, you can join us using this link - (discord.gg/2qdfk4tt). Here's how you can go about building your own bot for Discord.

GET NODE.JS AND A DISCORD ACCOUNT

This is fairly basic. Head over to discordapp.com and create an account for yourself. Building a bot and letting it operate within the Discord environment requires access to the Discord API and you require an auth token for the same. Once you've created a Discord account and have logged in to the account, navigate to discordapp.com/developers/applications/me and create an application.

If your account is logged in, you will be given a dialogue prompt to enter a name for your Discord bot. We put down "Bobby-B-DiscordBot", a fairly long name for an app.

Click on create and you should end up on the homepage of the app. Over here, you should see the name of the bot you've just entered, an icon (which can be updated with an image of your choosing), description panel, client ID and client secret. Copy the client ID which is a string of numbers and keep that for later. Add a description for your bot if you want to. On the left-hand side, you'll see Settings panel with an option that reads "Bots".



Developer Portal on Discord